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Horses, musicians & gods

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Section Title(S)

Dan Galadima (the Prince) • Inna (Fulani: Mother)

The third song illustrates some of the difficulties involved in creating a visual representation of expert lute-playing. The first four 'measures' are a fairly phonetic transcription of the garaya line, but when the voices enter the realization of any detail becomes impossible. The barest outline of the accented pattern in the earlier measures is given, but it is emphasized that this is a grossly simplified version of what the garaya player is actually doing. The gourd-rattle pattern continues with its previous shape, although the tapping of the players' fingers (to which a set of cowrie shells are tied, producing a percussive effect) and a slightly elaborated shake of the gourd give the second half of the pattern a complex character (see Example 5).

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Dan Galadima (the Prince)

PERSONALIA. Dan Galadima has been said to be the son of Malam Alhaji (the Pilgrim) (Greenberg 1946: 42), and one of his praise-epithets recorded in Kano agrees with this. Informants stress that he is not his real son but his brother's son. As already noted, it seems Dan Galadima is the real son of Sarkin Aljan Biddarene (House 2) but was given for adoption to his father's brother Sarkin Aljan Sulemanu.⁶ In the manner customary among the Hausa he may be described as the son of any or all of these three senior male spirits.

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Dan Galadima has four wives and one concubine: ' *Yar Mairo* (who is the daughter of a musician), *Ciwo Babu Magani* (Illness with no Medicine: the daughter of a sorcerer), *Ci Goro* (Eat Kolanuts), *Azurfa* (Silver), and *Mai Fitila*

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(Owner of a Lamp; his concubine). His children by these women have all been adopted by his father's brother's son, *Sarkin Rafi* (Chief of Well-Watered Land), in exchange for the children of his male parallel cousins. The result of these adoptions is that his own and his parallel cousin's children live with their real grandfathers with whom they have a joking relationship.

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A spendthrift and habitual gambler, providing for his wives is not easy for Dan Galadima.

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AFFLICTION. It is said in one of his praise-epithets,

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Katala turu bawam modi, turu dan na gode
spendthrift, one heavily in debt, slave of gambling; one heavily in
debt, son of 'I give thanks' ⁷
bad da naka, bad da na danginka .
lose your own, lose that of your relatives.

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Literary Texts

For one possessed by Dan Galadima the compulsion to give everything away has another side since it is believed that all will come back with interest. In fact the gifts in return are so large they must be carried one at a time:

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sha makara ganji mai fatan ganye, ganyen ganji
enjoy brimfulness, gutta-percha tree (*Ficus platyphylla*) with wide
leaves, the leaves of the gutta-percha
akwiya dauki da dai-dai da dai-dai .
are carried by the goat one at a time.

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Literary Texts

Reuke lists Dan Galadima as the real son of Sarkin Aljan and Inna (1969: 115). This conforms fairly well with the present data except that he is an adopted, not real son, of his parents. Reuke's diagrams make no distinction between real and adopted children.

dan na gode (son of I give thanks) is usually taken to be the praise-epithet of a strong, short man. Informants explain that here it means that Dan Galadima will take anything from anyone, saying 'thanks' and lose it in gambling.

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